MONTHLY UPDATE

Africa: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

PROGRESS

INSTITUTIONS AND MANDATES
Regional collaboration

INSTRUMENTS AND HARMONISATION
Data protection · Standards · AI

SHARED SYSTEMS AND INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Data Storage · Energy · Cybersecurity · Data Exchange · Digital Payments and Fintech · Sectoral management information systems

COORDINATION AND COLLABORATION
Innovation ecosystem · China activities · India activities

CAPACITY AND INCLUSION
Training and skills · Digital divides

FINANCE
MoUs and other agreements · New investments

Institutions and mandates

Regional collaboration

AFCFTA DIGITAL TRADE CORRIDOR

- **AfCFTA Digital Trade Corridor to Cut Cost of Intra-African Commerce - Wamkele Mene** — MyDailyNewsOnline, 1 September 2026 GHANA

  The AfCFTA Secretary-General set out the case for the Digital Trade Corridor: cutting the cost and complexity of intra-African business by ending the routing of African payments through third countries.

AFRICA PROSPERITY DIALOGUES 2027

- **Africa Prosperity Dialogues 2027 to push for 'borderless Africa' as registration opens September 7** — MyJoyOnline, 2 September 2026

  APD 2027 set for Accra 27-29 Jan 2027; RECs endorsed a continent-wide mobile money interoperability framework by 2027.

- **Africa's integration will fail without harmonised standards and laws - AUDA-NEPAD official** — Asaase Radio, 2 September 2026

  AUDA-NEPAD's Amine Idriss Adoum - over 1,000 integration decisions adopted, fewer than 15% implemented.

CAIRO DECLARATION ON CHILD RIGHTS AND DESIGN ACCOUNTABILITY

- **Osinbajo, African Lawyers Seek Accountability From Tech Firms Over Risks to Children** — Premium Times, 2 September 2026 EGYPT

  African lawyers meeting in Cairo reviewed and prioritised six pillars of a proposed declaration on children's rights and design accountability, covering safety-by-design requirements, restrictions on exploitative targeting and manipulative practices, and age-appropriate design standards. The session chair argued companies cannot engineer risk into products and then leave children and parents to manage it.

CENTRAL AFRICAN REGIONAL FRAMEWORK ON CROSS-BORDER DATA FLOWS

- **La CEEAC veut sécuriser sa frontière numérique** — Infos Gabon, 4 September 2026

  ECCAS member states met in Douala from 31 August to 4 September to draft a regional framework governing cross-border data flows in Central Africa, assessing national readiness and consolidating country contributions into a consensus on the pillars of a future instrument. Technical and financial support came from GIZ, AUDA-NEPAD, the Economic Commission for Africa and the African Union Commission.

KOREA-AFRICA ECONOMIC COOPERATION MINISTERIAL FRAMEWORK

- **Korea-Africa Ministerial Conference Convenes Under AI Theme, Two Weeks After Seoul's First AI Loan to the Continent** — iAfrica.com, 5 September 2026 TANZANIA

  KOAFEC Trust Fund leverage: US$50m of project preparation since 2007 against US$6bn pipeline and US$4bn mobilised.

- **2026 KOAFEC Ministerial Conference** — eTrade for all, 8 September 2026

  8th KOAFEC ministerial, Seoul, 8-11 September 2026: Harnessing AI and Digital Infrastructure for Africa's Transformation.

- **Korea Eximbank expands Africa financing in AI, critical minerals** — The Korea Herald, 10 September 2026

  Korea's export-import bank signed a pact with the African Development Bank in Seoul to expand financing for African projects in artificial intelligence, critical minerals and green infrastructure. It was signed during the eighth Korea-Africa economic cooperation ministerial, and the two institutions are to seek expanded joint financing including in digital infrastructure.

- **Le sommet Coree du Sud-Afrique aboutit sur des accords pour la creation d'un hub pour l'IA** — RFI, 12 September 2026

  The Korea-Africa economic cooperation summit, KOAFEC, closed in Seoul on 11 September 2026 with agreements between the African Development Bank and South Korea towards an AI hub for Africa. One is a memorandum on co-financing and preparing government projects; no sums are reported.

- **Africa–Korea: a strengthened partnership to accelerate innovation, investment and the continent's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 15 September 2026

  AfDB and Korea sign a letter of intent, 9 Sept 2026; KOAFEC Trust Fund at USD 132.82m to 31 May 2026.

- **African Development Bank and Korea's National Information Society Agency deepen partnership on Africa's AI and digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 16 September 2026

  The African Development Bank and Korea's National Information Society Agency signed a three-year letter of intent in Seoul on 9 September 2026 on data governance, AI-ready datasets and digital public infrastructure. The agency provides expertise and the bank identifies priorities and financing.

- **KOAFEC 2026: African Development Bank, KAIST sign agreement to advance Africa's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 16 September 2026

  The African Development Bank and Korea's KAIST signed a three-year letter of intent in Seoul on 9 September 2026 covering joint research on AI policy and datasets, advice on digital transformation and training for African officials and researchers. No funding figure is attached.

- **KOAFEC 2026: Korea and Africa adopt ambitious roadmap to accelerate continent's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 16 September 2026

  Korea, 45 African countries and the African Development Bank adopted a joint declaration and a 2027-2028 action plan in Seoul on 9 September 2026 centred on AI, digital infrastructure and skills. The plan names thirteen initiatives, among them a regional data embassy in Sierra Leone and compute credits for African AI start-ups; no sums are attached.

AFRICAN UNION ARCHIVES AND REPOSITORY PROJECT

- **African Union Commission Receives South African Delegation for Mission on the AU Archives and Repository Project** — African Union, 7 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  AUC receives a South African delegation in Addis Ababa on the reinstatement of the AU Archives and Repository Project.

ASSOCIATION OF REGULATORS OF INFORMATION AND COMMUNICATIONS FOR EASTERN AND SOUTHERN AFRICA (ARICEA)

- **COMESA Calls for Agile Regulation to Keep Pace with Africa's Rapid Digital Transformation** — Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA), 9 September 2026

  COMESA presses for predictable, agile regulatory frameworks at the 14th ARICEA annual general meeting in Livingstone.

AFRICAN TELECOMMUNICATIONS UNION (ATU)

- **ATU calls for stronger spectrum policy as Africa prepares for WRC-27** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026 TUNISIA

  The African telecommunications union's secretary-general called for stronger alignment among African administrations on spectrum policy, at the 11th Africa spectrum management conference in Tunis. He singled out the mid-band ranges where mobile broadband demand will need capacity and coordination, and argued that policy must extend beyond identifying frequencies to how spectrum is priced and licensed.

AFRICAN COMMON POSITION FOR THE ITU PLENIPOTENTIARY CONFERENCE 2026

- **AIP/ La Côte d'Ivoire appelle à une position africaine unie sur les enjeux du numérique à l'approche de la PP-26** — AIP - Agence Ivoirienne de Presse, 15 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Côte d'Ivoire bids for the ITU Council 2027-2030; 18 African candidates for 13 seats, says ATU's John Omo.

- **Télécommunications : La 4e et dernière réunion préparatoire africaine avant la PP-26 de Doha s'est ouverte à Abidjan** — Afrik Soir, 15 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Abidjan, 15-17 Sept 2026: Africa's last PP-26 prep meeting, and a USD 60,000 ATU Innovation Challenge.

- **Africa concludes final preparatory meeting ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference 2026** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  46 African Common Proposals settled as the Abidjan preparatory meeting closed, 17 September 2026.

- **ITU Africa Regional Director Emmanuel Manasseh highlights coordinated African priorities ahead of PP-26** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  ITU's Africa director names the next step: inter-regional preparatory meeting, Saudi Arabia 13-14 October.

- **Space regulation emerges as key issue ahead of ITU Plenipotentiary Conference 2026** — TechReviewAfrica, 18 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  France's ITU-R Bureau candidate Eric Fournier campaigns in Abidjan as space regulation dominates.

COMESA REGIONAL AI STRATEGY AND MODEL FRAMEWORK

- **PRESS STATEMENT: COMESA Advances Responsible AI Dialogue** — Digitalization in Eastern and Southern Africa (IDEA) / COMESA, 16 September 2026 ESWATINI

  COMESA statement: validated baseline to feed a Regional AI Strategy, model policy guidelines, model regulatory framework.

AFRICA INTERNET GOVERNANCE FORUM

- **UNECA Continental Call for African AI Innovations** — Africa Internet Governance Forum, 18 September 2026

  ECA, ITU and RIA open applications for an African AI showcase at AfIGF 2026, Accra 2-5 November.

AFRICAN FINANCIAL STABILITY REPORT

- **CBE governor heads Egypt delegation at 48th annual AACB meetings** — Daily News Egypt, 20 September 2026 EGYPT

  The Association of African Central Banks approved a second edition of the African Financial Stability Report and constituted the board of the African Monetary Institute, closing its 48th annual meetings in Nairobi with the governors of 34 of its 41 member central banks present. Egypt joined the Bureau of Governors as deputy chair for North Africa and chairs the taskforce preparing the report, which is to be published through the stability committee's portal.

AFRICAN MONETARY INSTITUTE

- **CBE governor heads Egypt delegation at 48th annual AACB meetings** — Daily News Egypt, 20 September 2026 EGYPT

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

AFRICAN CONTINENTAL HEALTH DATA GOVERNANCE FRAMEWORK

- **Health leaders to explore intelligent health systems at Kigali summit** — IGIHE, 27 September 2026 RWANDA

  Africa CDC and Smart Africa summit, Kigali, 30 Sep-2 Oct 2026; consultation on draft continental health data framework.

- **Africa CDC calls for stronger health data governance across Africa** — Tech Review Africa, 1 October 2026

  Africa CDC called on member states to strengthen national health data stewardship and adopt interoperable digital standards, at a consultative session at the Africa HealthTech Summit in Kigali.

- **Africa CDC official: Continent lacks infrastructure to run its own health AI** — The New Times, 3 October 2026 RWANDA

The head of digital health at the Africa Centres for Disease Control and Prevention said most health AI models presented to her are hosted on a foreign cloud, because the continent lacks the infrastructure to run them. The agency is drafting a continental health data governance framework with more than 40 member states, setting who may access health data, for what purpose and for how long.

MODEL LAW ON ACCESS TO INFORMATION FOR AFRICA (2013)

- **International Day for Universal Access to Information - 28 September 2026** — African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights, 28 September 2026

  The African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights will review its 2013 Model Law on Access to Information next year to add digital-age provisions. It also points to its guidelines for states on monitoring technology companies and for platforms serving the public interest, and to draft guidelines on access to data.

AFRINIC GOVERNANCE AND RECEIVERSHIP

- **AFRINIC Elections 2026 - Select the next PDP Co-Chair** — AFRINIC, 1 October 2026

  AFRINIC opened candidate registration for one of its two policy development co-chair seats, closing on 29 October. The seat will be filled at the public policy meeting on 18 November.

CAIRO DOCUMENT FOR TRUST AND AFRICAN DIGITAL INTEGRATION

- **African diplomats in Cairo agree to develop African digital integration roadmap** — Ahram Online, 4 October 2026 EGYPT

  Representatives of 11 African diplomatic missions in Cairo agreed to draft a joint Cairo Document for Trust and African Digital Integration. It is to set shared priorities on digital investment, digital trade, cybersecurity, data governance and emerging technologies.

GUIDELINES ON PUBLIC INTEREST CONTENT IN THE DIGITAL ERA

- **CALL FOR CONTRIBUTIONS: Draft Guidelines on Public Interest Content in the Digital Era** — African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights, 8 October 2026

  Draft V3 held; inputs due 8 January 2027; state duties and tech-company responsibilities under Res.631.

PRIMARY HEALTH CARE CONTINENTAL COORDINATION MECHANISM (DIGITAL HEALTH FORUM)

- **Primary Health Care Continental Coordination Mechanism (PHC-CCM) Outcome Statement** — Africa CDC, 8 October 2026

  Addis consultation 4-5 June 2026; digital health forum, maturity tool, costed investment cases, sovereign hosting.

Instruments and harmonisation

Data protection

NETWORK OF AFRICAN DATA PROTECTION AUTHORITIES (NADPA-RAPDP)

- **Signed-Sealed-Delivered: 21 September Africa Data Protection Day** — Tsitsi Mariwo (LinkedIn), 4 September 2026

  Fifth Board signs the declaration on 3 September 2026, executing the 9th AGM's May 2026 decision.

Standards

AFRICA PKI FORUM HARMONISATION OF DIGITAL-TRUST RULES

- **Africa cannot outsource its digital sovereignty - NIMC** — Newsverge Nigeria News, 2 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Odusote on homegrown cryptography and PKI; Mene warns of digital fragmentation at GITEX Nigeria.

- **GITEX Nigeria 2026: NIMC Boss Urges African Digital Framework** — Techeconomy, 3 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Coker-Odusote on PKI, NIMC as root CA under the Identity Management Act 2026, and state-level alignment.

- **Lagos, NIMC, AfCFTA demand local data sovereignty at GITEX 2026** — The Guardian Nigeria, 3 September 2026 NIGERIA

  NIMC, AfCFTA and Lagos press for African-owned DPI, with PKI as the cross-border trust layer.

AFRICAN COMMON PROPOSALS FOR WRC-27

- **3rd African Preparatory Meeting for WRC-27 (APM27-3) and the 11th African Spectrum Management Conference** — African Telecommunications Union (ATU), 7 September 2026 TUNISIA

  Draft agenda and GT1A-GT5 working-group schedule for the Tunis WRC-27 preparatory meeting, 7-11 September 2026.

- **African Delegations Seek Common Ground in Tunis Ahead of 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference** — African Telecommunications Union (ATU), 9 September 2026 TUNISIA

  Four days of African regulator talks from 8 September 2026 on broadband, rural connectivity and spectrum before WRC-27.

- **ATU calls for stronger spectrum policy as Africa prepares for WRC-27** — TechReviewAfrica, 10 September 2026 TUNISIA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **African Delegations Demand Common Ground In Tunis Ahead Of 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference** — Cyber Era, 17 September 2026 TUNISIA

  African governments and regulators opened four days of talks in Tunis to build common positions on the radio frequencies used by mobile, satellite and other wireless services, ahead of the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference. Broadband capacity, rural connectivity and future communications technologies are the focus.

- **South Sudan Advances Satellite Connectivity Agenda at African Telecom Meeting** — TechAfrica News, 17 September 2026 SOUTH SUDAN

  South Sudan's National Communication Authority took part in the third African preparatory meeting for the 2027 World Radiocommunication Conference, held in Tunisia. Non-geostationary satellite systems and direct-to-device connectivity were among the items African regulators worked on for common regional positions.

AFRINIC IPV6 POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-V6-001 (IPV6 AS A CRITERION IN IPV4 SOFT LANDING)

- **AFRINIC's IPv6-for-IPv4 Rule Needs a Control Test** — BTW Media, 7 September 2026

  A draft AFRINIC policy would tie any new IPv4 request to IPv6 eligibility, a deployment plan and percentage targets over 12, 24 and 48 months. The registry's own impact assessment says the evidence standard and the top-25 measurement method are not defined and warns smaller operators may face a disproportionate burden; AFRINIC 37 reached no consensus and the proposal returned to the mailing list.

- **IPv6 as a criteria in IPv4 Soft Landing (AFPUB-2026-v6-001-DRAFT02)** — AFRINIC, 14 June 2026

  AFRINIC's own proposal text and impact assessment for gating IPv4 on measured IPv6 deployment.

AFRINIC POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-GEN-001-DRAFT02 (PDP WORKING GROUP GUIDELINES AND PROCEDURES)

- **PDP Working Group (WG) Guidelines and Procedures (AFPUB-2026-GEN-001-DRAFT02)** — AFRINIC, 7 September 2026

  Under Discussion: Regional Number Council, community appeal and recall, PDWG petition to ratify when Board absent.

- **AFRINIC's proposed policy petition is a Board-absence mechanism** — BTW Media, 11 October 2026

  An analysis of the second draft of AFRINIC's policy-process guidelines finds that its petition route, which lets the working group seek ratification of a policy, opens only when no operative Board exists. It needs 15 supporters from three subregions and still depends on a change to the Bylaws.

AFRINIC POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-GEN-003-DRAFT01 (PUBLIC POLICY MEETING DATES)

- **[rpd] New draft policy proposal PPM Dates AFPUB-2026-GEN-003-DRAFT01** — AFRINIC Resource Policy Discussion (RPD) mailing list, 17 September 2026

  AFPUB-2026-GEN-003-DRAFT01 tabled 14 September; PDWG splits over whether meeting dates belong in the PDP.

- **[rpd] RPD Digest, Vol 224, Issue 17** — AFRINIC Resource Policy Discussion (RPD) mailing list, 18 September 2026

  PDWG voices split on whether AFRINIC meeting dates belong in the PDP or in board and staff operations.

ITU DIGITAL FINANCIAL SERVICES SECURITY RECOMMENDATIONS

- **How an ITU security lab advances trust in digital financial services** — International Telecommunication Union (ITU), 23 September 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  CRASA and EACO adopted ITU DFS security guidelines, WATRA at draft; 20+ countries assisted, 8 now test independently.

AFRINIC IPV4 POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-IPV4-001 (SOFT LANDING, RECOVERED SPACE AND PRIORITY)

- **AFRINIC ratifies three policies with different implementation clocks** — btw.media, 7 October 2026

  Three clocks: six-month IPv4 cleanup, 30-day utilisation change, AS-SET rule after MyAFRINIC v2.

AFRINIC IPV4 POLICY PROPOSAL AFPUB-2026-IPV4-002 (WAIVER OF THE 90% UTILISATION THRESHOLD)

- **AFRINIC ratifies three policies with different implementation clocks** — btw.media, 7 October 2026

  Summarised under Standards.

AI

PAN-AFRICAN AI GOVERNANCE RESEARCH AND ADVOCACY PROJECT

- **Africa cannot afford to scale AI faster than it can govern it** — BusinessDay NG, 2 September 2026 NIGERIA

Roseline Ilori of Bridge57 Solutions argues that Africa cannot scale AI faster than it can govern it, and that the question worth asking is not how quickly the continent adopts the technology but whether the systems being deployed are safe, fair, transparent and accountable. The gap she names is institutional rather than technical: regulators unable to supervise automated systems, businesses that do not understand the risks, and citizens with no way to challenge an algorithmic decision.

TRAINING DATA FOR AFRICAN LANGUAGES

- **This AI research company wants to put 1,000 African languages into AI** — TechCabal, 8 September 2026

  A research lab founded in 2020 is building training data covering a thousand African languages, after finding what exists both scarce and poor.

USE OF AI TOOLS BY JUDICIAL OPERATORS, AND TRAINING FOR IT

- **African Court, UNESCO strengthen judicial capacity on responsible use of Artificial Intelligence – AI** — African Court on Human and Peoples' Rights, 15 September 2026

  Arusha, 15 September 2026: UNESCO finds 44% of judicial operators using AI tools, only 9% given training.

AU GUIDELINES ON AI GOVERNANCE AND REGULATION

- **WEBINAR 23-24 SEP 12:00 UTC – African Union Open Stakeholder Consultation on AI Governance and Regulation** — Internet Society News, 23 September 2026

  The African Union Commission is holding an open online consultation on 23 and 24 September on its draft Guidelines on AI Governance and Regulation, which implement the 2024 Continental AI Strategy. Day two covers regulation, security and standards, including the AU Model AI Law; written submissions are accepted until 30 September.

- **The AU's Question: What 55 Countries Need to Agree on Before Africa Can Govern AI** — Tech Africa News, 29 September 2026

  The African Union Commission's AI coordinator said 17 countries have now formally adopted national AI policies, against eight when the continental strategy was written, at the consultation on continental AI governance guidelines. Draft guidelines and a model AI law are being prepared for ministerial review.

HUB FOR AI AND DISABILITY INCLUSION (HAIDI) AND AFRICAN DISABILITY DATA NETWORK (ADDN)

- **How Africa's AI boom is leaving 100 million disabled citizens behind** — TechCabal, 24 September 2026
  GHANA KENYA

  A Hub for AI and Disability Inclusion (HAIDI), hosted by KNUST's Responsible AI Lab, and an African Disability Data Network were launched at the Global Data Festival in Nairobi with backing from IDRC, the UK FCDO and AI4D. They plan to map disability-related datasets, build three new datasets, assess how national AI strategies treat disability and fund three startups with grants of up to KES 5 million.

GLOBAL INDEX ON RESPONSIBLE AI, AFRICAN RESULTS

- **African AI governance dialogue calls for practical, context-responsive frameworks** — Tech Review Africa, 30 September 2026

  A pre-FIFAfrica dialogue convened by the Global Center on AI Governance, Digital Action and CIPESA called for African AI governance principles to be turned into concrete commitments on training data, worker participation and community interests.

ATLAS UMOJA AI POLICY WORKSTREAM (AUDA-NEPAD)

- **AUDA-NEPAD launches ATLAS Umoja AI Policy workstream** — Tech Review Africa, 1 October 2026

  The African Union's development agency launched and chairs an AI policy workstream, ATLAS Umoja, on AI governance and African-language AI. A mobile industry official said at the launch that fewer than 2% of African languages are meaningfully supported by today's AI models.

WORLD BANK AFRICA ECONOMIC UPDATE, OCTOBER 2026: BUILDING AI READINESS

- **Africa Economic Update, October 2026: Building AI Readiness** — World Bank, 1 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  0.6% of global data-centre capacity; 39 states with data-protection laws; AI governance pillar 41.6 vs 52.6 globally.

- **World Bank raises Africa's 2026 growth forecast, urges AI investments** — Reuters via CNBC Africa, 6 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  The World Bank's October Africa Economic Update urges Sub-Saharan governments to invest in AI for productivity and jobs, pointing to low-cost applications on affordable devices, shared data centres and stronger data-protection laws. It puts the region's 2026 growth at 4.3%, 0.3 of a point above its April forecast.

COMMISSION STUDY ON HUMAN AND PEOPLES' RIGHTS AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (RESOLUTION 473)

- **Paradigm Initiative's Statement to the African Commission on Human and Peoples' Rights on the Human Rights Situation in Africa at the 89th Ordinary Session** — Paradigm Initiative, 13 October 2026 GABON ZAMBIA

  Urges ACHPR to enforce Resolution 473 on AI and press Gabon to drop its under-16 social media ban.

Shared systems and infrastructure

Connectivity

IPV6 CAPABILITY ACROSS THE AFRINIC SERVICE REGION

- **IPv6 as a criteria in IPv4 Soft Landing (AFPUB-2026-v6-001-DRAFT02)** — AFRINIC, 14 June 2026

  Summarised under Standards.

5G FIXED WIRELESS ACCESS OPERATORS

- **The New Last Mile: Why African Broadband is Moving Outdoors** — Tech Africa News, 10 September 2026 KENYA NIGERIA SOUTH AFRICA

  40 operators live on 5G FWA across 37 African markets by May 2026; Safaricom at 132,060 FWA lines, up 53%.

AIRTEL AFRICA NETWORK EXPANSION PROGRAMME

- **Airtel Africa to Invest $1.1bn for Network Expansion across Africa** — ThisDay, 10 September 2026 NIGERIA

  A pan-African operator has earmarked US$1.1 billion for expanding and upgrading its network across its African operations, its chief executive said in a broadcast interview. He said spending has already risen from about US$120 million to US$390 million across 14 markets, with Nigeria its biggest.

MOBILE INTERNET USERS AND THEIR MEASURED ECONOMIC VALUE

- **GSMA Warns of Growing AI Divide as Smartphone Costs Rise in Emerging Markets** — Tech Africa News, 15 September 2026 GLOBAL

  An industry association's 2026 connectivity report warns of a divide between artificial intelligence haves and have-nots: more than 3.4 billion people do not use mobile internet although over 90 per cent of them live inside mobile broadband coverage, with smartphone affordability the obstacle.

- **Advancing digital connectivity in Africa: Charting Africa's path to 1 billion connected people by 2030** — GSMA Intelligence for the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa (PDAA), 21 September 2026

  The report behind the GSMA and PDAA roadmap, summarised under the launch. It counts 550 million internet users in Africa in 2025 (36% of the population) and projects about 700 million by 2030 on current trends. Halving the coverage and usage gaps could add some 514 million people and take the total past 1 billion.

- **GSMA and PDAA Unveil Roadmap to Close Africa's Mobile Internet Usage Gap and Connect One Billion People by 2030** — GSMA, 21 September 2026

  The GSMA and the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa launched a roadmap in New York on 21 September 2026 on how to reach 1 billion connected Africans by 2030. Based on 11 markets, it finds about 906 million people living within mobile broadband coverage but not using the mobile internet, against 122 million with no coverage at all. Its three priorities are moving over 600 million 2G and 3G connections to 4G or 5G, investing in energy and connectivity together, and reaching rural areas more cheaply.

ADVANCING DIGITAL CONNECTIVITY IN AFRICA ROADMAP (GSMA AND PDAA)

- **Advancing digital connectivity in Africa: Charting Africa's path to 1 billion connected people by 2030** — GSMA Intelligence for the Partnership for Digital Access in Africa (PDAA), 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **GSMA and PDAA Unveil Roadmap to Close Africa's Mobile Internet Usage Gap and Connect One Billion People by 2030** — GSMA, 21 September 2026

  Summarised under Connectivity.

ATU-TESPOK INTERNET EXCHANGE POINT ROADMAP

- **New Roadmap by Africa's Telecom Union and Kenya's Tech Industry Association Targets Cheaper, More Reliable Internet** — African Telecommunications Union (LinkedIn article), 11 October 2026

  57 IXPs in 36 countries (mid-2025); proposes continental coordination body, model national framework, IXP fund.

Data Storage

AFRICAN SHARE OF GLOBAL DATA-CENTRE CAPACITY

- **Interview: Liquid bets on AI as next growth frontier for Africa's fibre network** — TechTrends KE, 10 September 2026 KENYA

  The same operator is repositioning from connectivity provider to a layered artificial intelligence, cloud and cybersecurity business on top of its fibre backbone, its vice-president and chief executive said at a Nairobi conference. Connectivity becomes the foundation of digital infrastructure rather than the product, he argued, naming data-centre capacity as the concern African telecom executives raise most.

- **Africa's Green Data Centre Opportunity: Solar-Powered Server Farms** — TechTrends Africa, 17 September 2026

African data centres face grids that fail outright rather than merely cost too much, and operators are increasingly building solar-powered server farms from the start instead of retrofitting diesel-dependent ones. The continent holds under 1 per cent of global data-centre capacity, with an industry association putting the shortfall at 1,000MW across some 700 further facilities.

- **Data centers : WIOCC prépare un bond de capacités en Afrique avec l'appui américain** — La Tribune (Agence Ecofin), 18 September 2026

  ADCA puts Africa at about 360 MW live, 0.6% of world capacity, as DFC backs 25 MW more via WIOCC.

AMAZON WEB SERVICES INVESTMENT IN AFRICAN CLOUD INFRASTRUCTURE

- **AWS puts $2.3bn behind Africa's cloud, AI future** — ITWeb South Africa, 10 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  A large cloud provider says it has invested more than US$819 million in African infrastructure since 2018 and committed a further US$1.5 billion to 2029, with 154 services now available in its Cape Town region. Its general manager for Sub-Saharan Africa told a Johannesburg summit the Africa strategy is increasingly aimed at local developers building for regional markets, and claimed more than a million Africans trained in cloud and AI skills.

CONTINENTAL DATA-CENTRE CAPACITY AGAINST PROJECTED DEMAND

- **Africa's Billion Dollar AI Data Centre Rush Is Real. Its Power and Water Aren't.** — iAfrikan, 11 September 2026 EGYPT SOUTH AFRICA

  ADCA 2026: 360MW active, 238MW building, 656MW pipeline; McKinsey puts 2030 demand at 1.5-2.2GW.

UNDP AI INFRASTRUCTURE ACTIVATION PROGRAMME

- **Local AI compute infrastructure in Africa: Lessons from six country-hosted deployments on governance and effective use** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), Regional Bureau for Africa, 17 September 2026 KENYA MALAWI RWANDA SOUTH AFRICA TOGO ZAMBIA

  Six-country UNDP review: 21 AI applications identified, and usable data the weakest link, not the GPUs.

DATA CENTRES THE AFCFTA SECRETARIAT STATES DIGITAL TRADE REQUIRES

- **'Africa needs data centre surge' to keep up with the digital economy** — Sunday Times / Business Times, 19 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  The head of the continental free trade area told a conference that Africa should aim for more than 700 data centres within ten years to carry a digital economy he put at 700 billion dollars. About 260 are counted now, and he named South Africa, Nigeria and Kenya as the builds to replicate.

Energy

EMERGENT GRID PROJECT (COMPUTING LOAD AS A MINI-GRID ANCHOR CUSTOMER)

- **The Rockefeller Foundation and Mission 300 Accelerator Launch Demonstration to Test Whether AI Demand Can Help Finance Energy Access in Africa** — The Rockefeller Foundation, 24 September 2026 KENYA DRC SIERRA LEONE

  Compute as mini-grid anchor customer; Kenya, DRC, Sierra Leone pilots for about 85,000 people; community load first.

Cybersecurity

REPORTED CYBERCRIME LOSSES ACROSS THE CONTINENT

- **AI now enables 55% of cybercrime in Africa as losses hit $484m – CID** — GBC Ghana Online (Ghana Broadcasting Corporation), 2 September 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's police CID put Interpol's 2026 African Cyber Threat Assessment on the record at the awareness month launch: AI now enables 55% of reported cybercrime in Africa, with related losses of $484 million. CID director-general COP Lydia Yaako Donkor described generative AI supplying convincing phishing messages, cloned voices and synthetic images and video, with cryptocurrency, mule accounts and fraudulent investment schemes moving the proceeds — an industrialised, borderless ecosystem rather than isolated offending. She tied Ghana's exposure directly to the spread of mobile money, internet banking and instant transfers.

AFRICAN NETWORK OF CYBERSECURITY AUTHORITIES

- **'Morocco CyberSecurity Week' Kicks off in Rabat** — Maroc.ma (MAP), 12 October 2026 MOROCCO

  Morocco's information systems security directorate is hosting a three-day cybersecurity event in Rabat from 12 to 14 October, with an ITU exercise drawing representatives of about thirty countries. The African Network of Cybersecurity Authorities meets on its sidelines.

Data Exchange

AFRICA ACCELERATOR FOR DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE (AA4DPI)

- **CDPI on its session at the Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, 2–3 September 2026** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI), 3 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

  Two-day accelerator session, 2–3 Sept 2026: delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone, Zambia.

- **Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure (AA4DPI)** — United Nations Development Programme, 8 September 2026

  UNDP has published the standing description of its Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, led jointly by the Regional Bureau for Africa and the Digital and AI Hub, which supports countries to assess digital readiness, strengthen governance, build implementation capacity and develop investment-ready programmes across digital identity, digital payments and data exchange. Its first published cohort session ran on 2 and 3 September with delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia; no budget, duration or deliverable set is published for the accelerator itself.

- **UNDP's AA4DPI Programme Deepens South-South Cooperation on Digital Public Infrastructure** — United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), 8 September 2026 ETHIOPIA MALAWI RWANDA SIERRA LEONE ZAMBIA

  Delegations from Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia, with African Union representatives, concluded a two-week South-South learning mission to India on digital public infrastructure. Convened under UNDP's newly launched Africa Accelerator for Digital Public Infrastructure, it took delegates through New Delhi, Pune and Bengaluru to examine India's digital identity, payment and data exchange systems.

Digital Payments and Fintech

AFRICAN TAKE-UP OF CHINA'S CROSS-BORDER INTERBANK PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **Grey targets Africa-China trade with direct yuan payments** — TechCabal, 1 September 2026

  The cross-border payments startup Grey launched direct yuan payouts into Chinese bank accounts from dollar, euro, sterling and stablecoin balances, aimed at African importers trading with China.

- **Ecobank to join China's CIPS payments platform for yuan settlement** — CNBC Africa (Reuters), 9 October 2026

  Signing in China set for 10 Oct 2026; Ecobank in 34 countries; joint yuan settlement talks with Bank of China.

BANKS AND COUNTRIES CONNECTED TO PAPSS

- **PAPSS targets 100% African coverage within five years** — Businessday NG, 4 September 2026

  Second strategic plan: 30 countries and 200+ institutions live, 38 targeted by end-2026, South Africa out.

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 NIGERIA

  30 countries live, 38 targeted by end-2026; stablecoins explored; Nigeria-Rwanda flows nearing Nigeria-Ghana.

- **ABC Bank goes live on intra-African pay system** — Business Today Kenya, 7 September 2026 KENYA

  Kenyan bank live on PAPSS to 28 countries and over 190 banks, with a choice of shilling or recipient-currency settlement.

- **PAPSS transactions grow over 1,000% as Africa deepens cross-border payments** — The Sun (Nigeria), 7 September 2026

  The continental payment system's chief executive put transaction volume growth above 1,000% and value growth at 125% since 2022, with settlement averaging seven seconds against an original 120-second design target and an artificial-intelligence layer screening for suspicious activity before value is released. He declined to give the absolute volume and value, saying disclosure is still being agreed and a report will follow in early 2027.

- **Can PAPSS overcome regulatory hurdles to transform intra-African payments?** — TechCabal, 10 September 2026

  An account of what the pan-African payment system has built in four years and the regulatory obstacles still limiting it: 30 countries connected, about 200 financial institutions, and cross-border payments settling in an average of seven seconds against a 120-second design target. The system says it has cut the cost of cross-border transfers by up to 95 per cent and that volumes have grown more than tenfold over the past year.

- **PAPSS targets accelerated adoption and transaction growth as network expands across Africa** — African Export-Import Bank, 11 September 2026

  Volumes up about 1,000% and values about 120% year on year to September 2026; 30-plus countries, 24 central banks.

- **PAPSS goes live at I&M Bank Kenya to expand cross-border payments** — TechReviewAfrica, 20 September 2026 KENYA

  The Pan-African Payment and Settlement System went live for customers of I&M Bank Kenya, the second Kenyan bank on the network. Customers can send to participating African markets in Kenyan shillings through the bank's branches rather than converting into an international currency; no volume, fee or corridor detail was published.

PAN-AFRICAN PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (PAPSS)

- **PAPSS targets 100% African coverage within five years** — Businessday NG, 4 September 2026

Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **'Africa's payment system is shaping global finance landscape positively'** — The Nation (Nigeria), 6 September 2026

  PAPSS CEO: 30 countries, 24 central banks live; 7-second average settlement; China and India links due Q1 2027.

- **PAPSS transactions grow over 1,000% as Africa deepens cross-border payments** — The Sun (Nigeria), 7 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **PAPSS: Notes from a briefing with CEO Mike Ogbalu III** — Nigeriaworks (Tolu Ogunlesi), 7 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Named-analyst notes from Ogbalu's Lagos briefing: phase one was spread, phase two from 2027 is deepening.

- **Nigeria, fintechs critical to Africa's payment integration** — The Sun Nigeria, 8 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Ogbalu Q&A on local-currency settlement, fraud controls, FX and formalising informal cross-border trade.

- **Afreximbank plans PAPSS-Instapay link to expand Egypt-Africa cross-border payments** — Ahram Online, 9 September 2026 EGYPT

  Ogbalu at the Cairo Middle East and Africa Conference: PAPSS to connect to Egypt's state-backed Instapay.

- **Can PAPSS overcome regulatory hurdles to transform intra-African payments?** — TechCabal, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

- **PAPSS Targets China, India Payment Markets by Early 2027** — Todays Echo, 10 September 2026

  The pan-African payment system plans to connect to China's largest payment system and to have India's live on its platform by the first quarter of 2027, its chief executive told a Lagos media session, with Brazil and others later in the year. He put transaction volumes up more than 1,000 per cent year on year and 30 countries connected against about 38 targeted by the end of 2026.

- **PAPSS payments grew 1,000% in a year, and Kenya is now on the network** — tech-ish, 17 September 2026 KENYA

  Payments across the pan-African settlement network are reported to have grown about tenfold over the year while the average payment fell to about a fifth of its level a year earlier — many small transfers in place of a few large ones. Kenya's national switch is the first of its kind piloted for termination on the network.

STABLECOIN SETTLEMENT RAILS SERVING AFRICAN CROSS-BORDER PAYMENTS

- **Nigerian churches drive rising cross-border payments across Africa, PAPSS says** — Nairametrics, 5 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

COST OF SENDING US$200 TO SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

- **How Remittance Startups Are Undercutting Western Union Across Africa** — TechTrends Africa, 6 September 2026 NIGERIA

  Sending $200 to Sub-Saharan Africa cost 8.46% in Q3 2025; app rivals run London-Lagos at 2-3%.

COMMERCIAL STABLECOIN PAYOUT RAIL ACROSS AFRICAN MARKETS

- **DCSPay Partners With Kotani Pay to Expand Stablecoin Payouts Across Africa** — Tech Africa News, 8 September 2026

  A stablecoin payments platform partnered a local payout provider to widen stablecoin payout and settlement across African markets.

TERRAPAY-ALIPAY+ CROSS-BORDER QR ACCEPTANCE

- **TerraPay and Alipay+ Partner to Enable Cross-Border QR Payments for African Wallets** — Tech Africa News, 9 September 2026

  TerraPay and Alipay+ announced a partnership to enable cross-border QR payments for African digital wallets. In the initial phase 15 African wallets connected to TerraPay's Xend interoperability network would be able to pay at more than 150 million merchants, extending the network from account-to-account transfers into in-store payments.

REGULATORY OBSTACLES TO INSTANT PAYMENT INTEROPERABILITY

- **Can PAPSS overcome regulatory hurdles to transform intra-African payments?** — TechCabal, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

ASSOCIATION OF AFRICAN CENTRAL BANKS (AACB)

- **CBE Governor discusses AI applications in central banks at AACB meetings** — Ahram Online, 17 September 2026 EGYPT

  A high-level conference on artificial intelligence in central banking ran on the sidelines of the Association of African Central Banks' 48th annual meetings in Nairobi, covering AI in monetary policy and financial stability, in supervision and financial integrity, and in governance and risk management, with national readiness and regional cooperation on frameworks for responsible use.

- **Annual Meetings - Nairobi 2026** — AACB, 18 September 2026 KENYA

  The Association of African Central Banks held its 48th annual meetings in Nairobi from 13 to 18 September, hosted by the Central Bank of Kenya alongside its sixtieth-anniversary events and an AI conference. The published programme names the technical committee, bureau and assembly sittings and the member banks attending each.

PAPSSCARD

- **Egypt's Meeza Cards Set for Wider African Use Through PAPSS Integration** — WAYA, 20 September 2026 EGYPT

  Afreximbank is connecting the continental card scheme to Egypt's Meeza national card network so cards issued on either side work across more African markets. The first phase joins the two infrastructures and establishes a settlement layer; payment would be in the currency of the country being visited, and no availability date was given.

MASTERCARD WALLET PAY (WALLET INTEROPERABILITY SERVICES)

- **Mastercard Launches Wallet Pay to Expand Digital Wallet Interoperability Globally** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Mastercard launched Wallet Pay, a set of services letting digital wallets accept contactless, QR and online payments across its network. MTN and AXIAN are among the launch partners, alongside Alipay+ and others.

VERTO CARD (MULTI-CURRENCY CORPORATE CARD ON VISA)

- **Verto and Visa Launch Multi-Currency Corporate Cards for African Businesses** — Tech Africa News, 22 September 2026

  Payments platform Verto and Visa launched the Verto Card, a corporate card for African businesses that funds and settles in 11 currencies with no FX markup on eligible ones and indirect access to 160 more. It runs on Visa's commercial rails rather than prepaid rails, which Verto blames for declined cross-border payments.

AIRTEL MONEY

- **Airtel Mobile Commerce N.V. - Intention to Float (RNS 9490V)** — Airtel Mobile Commerce N.V. (Airtel Money), via the London Stock Exchange Regulatory News Service, 23 September 2026

  RNS 9490V; IFC cornerstone up to £67.2m; existing holders sell, no new capital; TPV US$213bn; Airtel Africa holds 77.85%.

- **Airtel Africa plc - Airtel Money announcement of offer price (RNS 1687X)** — Airtel Africa plc, via the London Stock Exchange Regulatory News Service (Reuters REG feed on TradingView), 1 October 2026

  Airtel Africa's regulatory announcement gives the terms of the Airtel Money offer: existing shareholders sell 270 million shares, with up to 27 million more under an over-allotment option, leaving about 16.5% of the company in public hands. Airtel Africa sells only through the over-allotment option.

- **Airtel Money Sets IPO Price at £1.96 Per Share, Valuing Company at £5.3 Billion** — Tech Africa News, 1 October 2026

  Airtel Money set the price of its London share offer at GBP1.96, valuing the company at about GBP5.3 billion. Trading is expected to begin on 14 October.

- **Airtel Money begins trading on London Stock Exchange after an oversubscribed IPO** — The Financial Express, 12 October 2026

  Airtel Money began conditional trading on the London Stock Exchange on 9 October after an oversubscribed offer in which existing shareholders sold 270 million shares, raising about US$703 million. The shares ended just below the offer price on the first day, and unconditional dealings were due on 14 October.

INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEMS IN OPERATION

- **Access or usage? The financial inclusion impact of Africa's instant payments systems** — AfricaNenda, 29 September 2026

  AfricaNenda's 2026 report on inclusive instant payment systems finds, on data from 54 economies, that a live instant payment system raises how often account holders use their accounts but not account ownership. The average transaction fell from US$58 in 2021 to US$25.

MASTERCARD COLLABORATIONS WITH THE MOJALOOP FOUNDATION AND AFRICANENDA

- **Mastercard Partners With Mojaloop and AfricaNenda to Strengthen Instant Payments in Africa** — TechAfrica News, 30 September 2026

Mastercard announced it will explore pairing its A2A Protect fraud and dispute service with the Mojaloop Foundation's open-source instant-payment software, and will support AfricaNenda on instant-payment policy and governance. No country, sum or timetable was stated.

PAYMENT SYSTEMS DIRECTIVE FOR AFRICA (PSDA)

- **Africa needs $120m, AU law to fix cross-border payments – AU** — The Sun Nigeria, 5 October 2026

  Three gates: binding AU instrument, AACB supervisor, US$120m fund; 10-year plan, five REC pathfinders, NGA-GHA corridor.

- **Africa Eyes One Digital Payment Market Without A Single Currency** — Digitnomics, 6 October 2026

  Licence passporting, ISO 20022, e-KYC; 10-year readiness roadmap; Nigeria-Ghana as potential pathfinder.

- **African Fintechs Seek One Licence For Continent-Wide Expansion** — Digitnomics, 7 October 2026

  African payment companies are pressing for licence passporting, under which a firm licensed in one country could operate in others without starting again. It is part of the African Union Commission's work with AfricaNenda on cross-border payment rules.

- **AfricaNenda trains Journalists On Inclusive Instant Digital Payments** — News Agency of Nigeria, 7 October 2026

  AfricaNenda says its payments regulation initiative with the African Union Commission has moved to implementation after a feasibility study found a harmonised framework workable. The study names eight priority areas, licence passporting and interoperability standards among them, and a phased roadmap.

COMESA REGIONAL PAYMENT AND SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (REPSS)

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  MAURITIUS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  BoM governor, July 2026: SSA to miss 2027 G20 targets; REPSS, TCIB, PAPSS as building blocks; stablecoin risks.

SADC REAL-TIME GROSS SETTLEMENT SYSTEM (SADC-RTGS)

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  MAURITIUS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

TRANSACTIONS CLEARED ON AN IMMEDIATE BASIS (TCIB)

- **Cross-border payments as a necessity for Africa's resilience and economic transformation** — Bank for International Settlements (central bankers' speeches); speech by the Bank of Mauritius, 13 October 2026

  MAURITIUS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Sectoral management information systems

CONTINENTAL BEHAVIOURAL INTELLIGENCE AND INFODEMIC MANAGEMENT FRAMEWORK

- **Africa CDC Calls for Stronger Community Engagement and Behavioural Intelligence to Boost Health Security** — Ommy Dallah, 3 September 2026 KENYA

  Mombasa workshop harmonises a continental behavioural-intelligence and infodemic framework.

- **Africa CDC advances public health intelligence framework** — The Star (Kenya), 4 September 2026 KENYA

  Africa CDC and member states validated components of a continental behavioural intelligence and infodemic management framework at a five-day meeting in Mombasa, with participants from six countries alongside the ECOWAS regional surveillance centre and the WHO Africa Infodemic Response Alliance. The framework is to turn community feedback, social listening, service-delivery and programme data and rapid research into decision-ready intelligence; Africa CDC states it is not another database or reporting platform.

REGIONAL HEALTH DATA HUB

- **WHO launches Regional Health Data Hub to turn health data into informed action** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 7 September 2026

  The regional health data hub launched at Addis Ababa carries 53 datasets and 7,965 indicators, about 65% of them ingested against a target of 80% by the end of 2026, and its governance framework is still in development. It is intended to bring maternal, newborn, child and adolescent health together with noncommunicable disease data across all 47 member states of the region.

BEHAVIOURAL INTELLIGENCE FRAMEWORK AND DATA ARCHITECTURE

- **Africa CDC To Harmonise Behavioural Intelligence** — LEADERSHIP Newspapers, 17 September 2026

  The continental health agency, with member states and technical partners, has validated a framework, a strategy, a digital and data architecture and a roadmap for harmonising behavioural intelligence and infodemic management, at a five-day workshop in Mombasa. None of the four documents is published.

DIGIT-HCM HEALTH-CAMPAIGN DIGITISATION INITIATIVE

- **WHO Africa launches the Health Campaign Digitization initiative (DIGIT-HCM) to transform health campaign planning and delivery across the Region** — WHO Regional Office for Africa, 25 September 2026 CHAD

  Three-year platform with eGov Foundation, Gates-backed; seven pilot countries, first run in Chad's June 2026 polio drive.

Coordination and collaboration

Innovation ecosystem

ATU AFRICA INNOVATION CHALLENGE

- **ATU opens fifth Africa Innovation Challenge with US$60,000 prize pool** — TechReviewAfrica, 17 September 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Fifth edition launched in Abidjan by Cote d'Ivoire's digital minister; AI software solutions sought.

China activities

AFRICAN MEMBERSHIP OF THE WORLD ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE COOPERATION ORGANISATION

- **Opening the AI gateway** — China.org.cn, 1 September 2026

  Mazu weather-warning deals with Cote d'Ivoire, Guinea and Cameroon; 10 African states found WAICO in Shanghai.

CHINESE INTELLIGENT WEATHER-WARNING SYSTEM IN AFRICA

- **Opening the AI gateway** — China.org.cn, 1 September 2026

  Summarised under China activities.

India activities

INDIA-AFRICA DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE COOPERATION

- **African delegations study India's digital identity systems under UNDP mission** — Biometric Update, 9 September 2026

  Ethiopia, Malawi, Rwanda, Sierra Leone and Zambia complete a two-week UNDP AA4DPI mission across Delhi, Pune, Bengaluru.

Capacity and inclusion

Training and skills

PAN-AFRICAN MEDIA INNOVATION PROGRAMME

- **MTN, UJ, TAEF Launch Pan-African Media Innovation Programme for 42 Journalists** — Tech Africa News, 1 September 2026

  First cohort: 42 journalists from 10 countries join MTN's six-week Pan-African media programme.

LEADERSHIP EXCELLENCE IN AFRICA'S PUBLIC SECTOR (LEAPS) PROGRAMME

- **Africa urged to put leadership at centre of public sector reforms** — The Star (Kenya), 3 September 2026

  KENYA GHANA SENEGAL ZIMBABWE GAMBIA CÔTE D'IVOIRE ETHIOPIA NIGERIA TANZANIA

  The African Capacity Building Foundation argued that sound policies and public financial management reforms are failing at implementation because of leadership gaps, institutional fragmentation and resistance to change.

REGIONAL TRAINING IN DIGITAL LAND RECORD SYSTEMS

- **RCMRD Trains 55 African Officials on Digital Land Record Systems in Nairobi** — Space in Africa, 17 September 2026

  A regional mapping centre is training 55 officials from its 20 member states on planning and managing digital land record systems, over five days in Nairobi. The course covers bringing surveying, registration, valuation and mapping into one system, connecting it to national platforms so information is not re-entered, data accuracy and access control, and where state data should be hosted.

AI TRAINING FOR AFRICAN PUBLIC OFFICIALS (AFDB, UNDP AI HUB, GOOGLE, APOLITICAL)

- **UNGA81: African Development Bank Group and partners launch free AI training for African public officials** — African Development Bank Group, 24 September 2026

  Free self-paced courses on AI fundamentals, leadership and procurement for officials; Stanford and SDA Bocconi content.

HER CYBERTRACKS WOMEN'S CYBERSECURITY PROGRAMME

- **Nearly 50 African women cybersecurity professionals gather in Addis Ababa for regional training** — Tech Review Africa, 24 September 2026

Nearly 50 women cybersecurity professionals from across Africa met in Addis Ababa for the Her CyberTracks Regional Training Africa 2026. The programme is funded by Germany, the European Commission and Italy and delivered by the ITU and GIZ with UNODC's Global Programme on Cybercrime.

IPRIS REGULATORY CAPACITY PROGRAMME

- **African telecom regulators convene in Nairobi to strengthen cooperation on emerging digital challenges** — iPRIS, 5 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  A European-funded regulatory capacity programme is holding its eighth cohort in Nairobi from 5 to 9 October. Regulators from Liberia, Mauritius, Namibia, Sierra Leone, Tanzania and Zimbabwe are taking part with three regional regulators' associations.

Digital divides

GENDER GAP IN INTERNET USE

- **Internet users in Africa and globally** — The Star (Kenya), 15 September 2026

  UNECA data 2019-2024: African men's internet use 43% against women's 31% in 2024, a 12-point gap.

SMARTPHONE SHIPMENTS AND ENTRY-LEVEL AFFORDABILITY

- **GSMA warns of emerging global AI divide as three billion people remain offline and smartphone component costs soar** — GSMA, 15 September 2026 GLOBAL

  SOMIC 2026: an entry handset costs the poorest fifth 76% of monthly income in Sub-Saharan Africa.

- **The State of Mobile Internet Connectivity 2026** — GSMA, 15 September 2026 SENEGAL GLOBAL

  Senegal adult survey: 87% urban and 75% rural use mobile internet, against 25% adoption across Sub-Saharan Africa.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

AUC-ITU COOPERATION MEMORANDUM

- **African Union Commission and ITU Sign MoU to Accelerate Africa's Digital Future** — African Union, 7 September 2026

  Motaboge and Bogdan-Martin sign a cooperation framework in Geneva on 7 September 2026; no commitment sum stated.

K-AI PACKAGE

- **S. Korea vows closer cooperation with African partners at KOAFEC meeting** — Yonhap News Agency, 9 September 2026 TANZANIA

  South Korea set out the K-AI Package at the 8th KOAFEC ministerial in Seoul, tying AI solutions, AI data centres and power supply facilities to infrastructure projects financed by its Economic Development Cooperation Fund. Delegations from 45 African countries adopted a joint declaration, approved 13 new trust-fund projects and signed a letter of intent for a Korea-Africa AI Hub at the African Development Bank. No commitment sum is stated.

- **The government has decided to cooperate with 45 African countries in the artificial intelligence (AI) sector** — Maeil Business Newspaper (MK), English edition, 9 September 2026

South Korea agreed to cooperate with 45 African countries on artificial intelligence, tying AI solutions, AI data centres and power supply facilities to projects financed by its Economic Development Cooperation Fund. No commitment sum is stated.

KOREA EXIMBANK-AFDB COOPERATION ON AI AND DIGITAL FINANCING

- **Korea Eximbank expands Africa financing in AI, critical minerals** — The Korea Herald, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

ECA-DHL MEMORANDUM ON SME CROSS-BORDER TRADE

- **ECA and DHL partner to advance MSMEs participation in intra-African trade** — UN Economic Commission for Africa, 14 September 2026

  Three-year non-exclusive MoU of 14 September 2026: virtual SME training on customs, logistics and digital trade.

- **UNECA, DHL Express Partner to Boost African SMEs in Cross-Border Trade Under AfCFTA** — The Reporter, 14 September 2026

  Three-year non-exclusive MoU on SME digital-trade training; no value and no signing date stated.

SMART AFRICA-KITSOFT MEMORANDUM ON PUBLIC-SECTOR DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION

- **Kitsoft and Smart Africa to cooperate on digital transformation of governments** — Smart Africa, 15 September 2026

  Smart Africa Secretariat signs MoU with Ukrainian GovTech firm Kitsoft on DPI, e-governance and AI.

- **Kitsoft and Smart Africa Sign MoU on Public Sector Digital Transformation** — Tech Africa News, 16 September 2026

  Smart Africa's secretariat signed a memorandum with Kitsoft, a GovTech firm of Ukrainian origin, on digital public infrastructure, e-government and AI, including building public services on low-code tools. No budget or country deployment is named.

KOREA-AFRICA AI HUB

- **Korea, African Development Bank sign deal to launch joint AI Hub to support Africa** — African Development Bank Group, 17 September 2026

  The African Development Bank and the Republic of Korea signed a letter of intent in Seoul to establish a joint hub for artificial intelligence, to support responsible development, adoption and financing of AI across the continent. It was signed on the sidelines of the eighth Korea-Africa ministerial conference; no capitalisation, host or start date is published.

- **South Korea, Africa pledge deeper AI partnership to accelerate continent's digital transformation** — African Development Bank Group, 17 September 2026

  At a press conference alongside the African Development Bank's president in Seoul, South Korea's deputy prime minister said Korea would deepen its partnership with Africa by expanding cooperation in artificial intelligence and digital technologies. The bank put AI's potential at up to US$1 trillion of African GDP by 2035.

ATU PARTNERSHIP WITH THE UN OFFICE FOR DIGITAL AND EMERGING TECHNOLOGIES

- **UNGA81: ATU calls for stronger protection of Africa's critical digital infrastructure** — Tech Review Africa, 22 September 2026

> ATU's John Omo at UN-ODET roundtable, UNGA81; cites July 2026 ATU-UN-ODET partnership on DPI and AI.

New investments

AFRICAN TECHNOLOGY EQUITY AND DEBT FUNDING

- **ChipMango raises $1.9 million to build Africa's chip-design talent** — TechCabal, 1 September 2026

  ChipMango, a California-headquartered chip design and engineering training company, closed a US$1.9 million seed round led by Atlantica Ventures to expand its engineering work and workforce platform across Africa.

INVESTMENT IN A CARRIER-NEUTRAL DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE PLATFORM

- **Africa Finance Corporation and Vision Invest — WIOCC Group equity investment, 2026** — Africa Finance Corporation, 1 September 2026

  The Africa Finance Corporation's own announcement of the combined US$300 million equity subscription with Vision International Investment Company, stating the proceeds as data-centre deployment and consolidation, expansion of open-access terrestrial fibre and investment in new subsea assets. See the WIOCC entries for the transaction.

- **WIOCC Group Secures $300 Million Investment From AFC, Vision Invest to Expand Africa's Digital Infrastructure** — Tech Africa News, 1 September 2026

  A third account of the same WIOCC subscription agreement, adding no new terms. See above.

- **WIOCC Group Secures Strategic Investment from AFC and Vision Invest to Accelerate its Digital Infrastructure Expansion Across Africa** — Africa Finance Corporation, 1 September 2026

  WIOCC's own announcement of the US$300 million subscription agreement sets out that the money is to accelerate its digital infrastructure expansion across Africa. See the entry above for the transaction.

AFDB-AXIAN DIGITAL FINANCE PROGRAMME FOR WOMEN-LED BUSINESSES

- **African Development Bank and AXIAN Launch Digital Finance Programme to Support 34,000 Women-led Businesses in Africa** — African Development Bank Group (distributed by APO Group), 2 September 2026
  MADAGASCAR TANZANIA SENEGAL TOGO COMOROS SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  AfDB and AXIAN's Mixx/Mvola programme targets 34,000 women-led businesses across a $49bn financing gap.

BOOST AFRICA

- **EU, EIB Invest EUR108m to Drive African Entrepreneurship, Create 15,000 Jobs** — THISDAYLIVE, 9 September 2026 NIGERIA

  EUR 108m committed under Boost Africa, EUR 400m leveraged and 15,000 jobs claimed.

- **EU, EIB Highlight Boost Africa's Impact On Entrepreneurs** — Voice of Nigeria, 10 September 2026 NIGERIA

  EUR108m placed through Boost Africa in a decade, leveraging about EUR400m more; EUR1 attracts EUR3.

UNITED STATES DEVELOPMENT FINANCE EQUITY IN A PAN-AFRICAN DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE OPERATOR

- **DFC Board of Directors Meeting, 16 September 2026 — Public Information Summary: WIOCC Holding Company Limited** — U.S. International Development Finance Corporation (DFC), 9 September 2026

  DFC's own board summary: up to $155m equity in WIOCC, $450m project, ~25MW of new data-centre capacity.

- **DFC Announces More Than $8 Billion in Investments to Fuel American Economic and National Security Interests** — U.S. International Development Finance Corporation, 16 September 2026

  DFC board approves equity in WIOCC Group among $8bn+ of new investments; no amount published.

- **US backs African digital infrastructure** — ITWeb Africa, 22 September 2026

  The US International Development Finance Corporation said it intends to invest US$155 million in WIOCC Group, joining Africa Finance Corporation and Vision Invest as investors. The announcement followed an AFC roundtable in New York during the UN General Assembly; WIOCC operates in more than 30 African countries.

- **DFC Highlights U.S. Leadership in Economic Statecraft on Sidelines of U.N. General Assembly** — U.S. International Development Finance Corporation (DFC), 25 September 2026

  WIOCC equity signed on UNGA81 sidelines with Vision and AFC executives present; release gives no amount.

- **The Money Was Already In The Room** — CIO Africa, 28 September 2026

  An analysis of WIOCC's funding notes that the US development finance agency joined a US$300m round three weeks after it was signed by a continental financier and a Saudi investor, with its own amount undisclosed and subject to congressional notification. It sets the round against data-centre costs of US$5-12m per megawatt, enough for tens rather than hundreds of megawatts.

UNITED KINGDOM DIGITAL DEVELOPMENT STRATEGY 2024-2030

- **FCDO Promises to Halve the Digital Divide. Where Is the Money?** — ICTworks, 10 September 2026 NIGERIA KENYA GHANA RWANDA

  UK's 2024-2030 digital strategy still live on GBP 70m over three years, most of it possibly one AI programme.

FSD AFRICA-FUNDED STARTUP ACQUISITION PROGRAMME

- **Pula and S2E want to solve Africa's startup problem with British aid money** — TechCabal, 16 September 2026 KENYA

  FSD Africa, a UK aid-funded agency, is paying the consultancy S2E Africa to find corporate buyers for African startups and help them through deals, with insurtech Pula among the first clients. FSD Africa takes no stake in the acquisitions.

SLOANE CAPITAL STARTUP AND MSME FUND AND THE KUMII MATCHING PLATFORM

- **The push to connect Africa's startups is getting $63 million and an AI platform** — TechCabal, 16 September 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Cape Town's 22 On Sloane launched KUMii, an AI platform matching startups and small firms to funders, tenders and mentors, with more than 4,000 already registered. Its lending arm, Sloane Capital, is raising R1 billion, about US$63 million, to finance them.

BOOST VENTURES IN AFRICA

- **Africa's leading venture capital fund managers convene at Oxford to strengthen investment expertise and advance venture investing across Africa** — European Investment Bank, 28 September 2026

  EUR 129m Commission guarantee launches Boost Ventures in Africa; EUR 4.5m EFSD+ technical assistance for VC funds.

AI 10 BILLION INITIATIVE

> - **African Development Bank and UNDP Advance AI 10 Billion Initiative to Turn Africa's AI Potential into Productivity** — African Development Bank, 14 October 2026
>
>   The African Development Bank and UNDP said the AI 10 Billion Initiative has moved to delivery after a UNDP mission to the Bank in Abidjan. It is to start in five countries and reach 20 by the end of 2027, arranging US$1 billion a year for ten years; no country, contributor or committed sum is named.

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